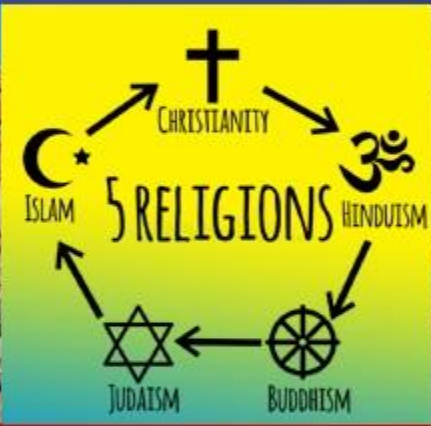


ART & CULTURE



INDIAN THEATRE

MODULE - 4

- FOLK THEATRES
- NOTES FROM CCRT

INDIAN THEATRE

FOLK THEATRE

RITUAL THEATRE

- Ankia Nat
- Kala
- Ramlila
- Raslila
- Bhuta

THEATRE OF ENTERTAINMENT

- Bhavai
 - Daskathia
 - Garodas
 - Jatra
 - Kariyila
 - Maach
 - Nautanki
- Swang
 - Tamasha
 - Villu Pattu
 - Oja-Pali
 - Pandavani
 - Powada

SOUTH INDIAN THEATRE

- Yakshagana
- Burra Katha
- Pagati Veshాలు
- Bayalata
- Tal-Maddale
- Theyyam
- Krishna Attam
- Kuruvanji

(This classification is done merely for easier understanding of students)

INDIAN THEATRE

FOLK THEATRE

THEATRES OF SOUTH INDIA

The speciality of the theatrical traditions of South India is the **emphasis on dance** as compared to the emphasis on music in Northern India.
Some of the popular theatres of South India are:



INDIAN THEATRE

FOLK THEATRE

THEATRES OF SOUTH INDIA

1

YAKSHAGANA



1

It is perhaps the oldest theatre traditions, which is prevalent till date in the regions of **Andhra Pradesh and Karnataka**.

2

It originated in the royals courts of the **Vijaynagar empire** and was performed by a particular community known as **Jakkula Varu**.

3

Originally, it was largely **descriptive dance-drama enacted by a single artist**.

4

Later forms adopted further variations and became a typical dance drama. Some of the popular variants of Yakshagana are **Lalita** in Maharashtra, **Bhavai** in Gujarat and **Gandharva Gana** in Nepal.

INDIAN THEATRE

FOLK THEATRE

THEATRES OF SOUTH INDIA

2

BURRA KATHA



- 1 Burra Katha is another popular dance-drama tradition of Andhra Pradesh.
- 2 It derives its name from Burra- the percussion instrument used extensively during the performance
- 3 The performance consists of main artist or narrator and two vanthas or co-artists who provide the rhythm as well as the chorus.

INDIAN THEATRE

FOLK THEATRE

THEATRES OF SOUTH INDIA

3

PAGATI VESHAALU



1

It is the folk tradition popular in the Telangana region as well as the Krishna district of Andhra Pradesh.

2

It is primarily a role-playing act, revolving around a principal character known as **vesham** (disguise) and other sub characters.

INDIAN THEATRE

FOLK THEATRE

THEATRES OF SOUTH INDIA

4

BAYALATA



- 1 It is an open-air theatre tradition of Karnataka that is performed during the worship of the local deity.
- 2 There are generally five types of Bayalatas – Dasarat, Sannata, Dodddata, Parijata and Yakshagana.
- 3 The stories are based on love of Radha-Krishna.
- 4 Parijata and Yakshagana are narrated by a single Sutradhara while the other three forms are performed in a chorus of three-four.

INDIAN THEATRE

FOLK THEATRE

THEATRES OF SOUTH INDIA

5

TAL-MADDALE



*Above- Maddale
Left- Tal*

- 1 Tal is a kind of cymbal and Maddale is a kind of drum.
- 2 It is generally considered as the predecessor of Yakshagana.
- 3 The play is performed while sitting and without any makeup, dance and acting.
- 4 The chief narrator is called the Bhagavata and his associates who aid him are called Arthadharis.



THEYYAM



6

THEYYAM



Theyyam: performance and ritual

<https://www.thehindu.com/society/history-and-culture/the-many-forms-of-theyyam/article22890760.ece/>

1

Theyyams are similar to the ritualistic Bhuta theatres of Karnataka.

2

It is performed in the local temples to honour the spirit of the deceased ancestors.

3

A village Theyyam is known as Otta Kolam, the tradition of which is mentioned in the Sangam literature of 500 B.C.

7

KRISHNA ATTAM

- 1 It is colourful dance-drama tradition of Kerala that originated in the mid 17th century.



2

- 2 It is a carnival that lasts for 8 days, with performances in 8 consecutive nights narrating the life story of Sri Krishna.



INDIAN THEATRE

FOLK THEATRE

THEATRES OF SOUTH INDIA

8

KURUVANJI

- 1 Originated around 300 years ago, Kuruvanji is characterized by classical Tamil poetry and songs.



- 2 The earliest Kuruvanji was composed by Thirukutarajappa Kavirayar and was known as Kutrala Kuruvanji.
- 3 In most of these kuruvanjis, the basic theme revolves around a heroine who is a goddess, a princess or a woman of good family who is in love with a God, or a king etc.
- 4 The kuruvanji or the gypsy is another important character who is a fortune teller.

INDIAN THEATRE

FOLK THEATRE

THEATRES OF SOUTH INDIA

8

KURUVANJI



*Viralimalai kuruvanji performed by
Dr Padma Subramaniam*

5

She foretells/predicts whether the heroine will win the love of her beloved.

6

Kuruvanji is performed in a dance ballet form with Bharatnatyam being the principal dance form.

7

Kuruvanji were most successfully performed by Pandanallur Meenakshisundaram Pillai's troupe, Rukmini Devi Arundale, Balasaraswathi, Mrinalani Sarabhai.

ART & CULTURE



INDIAN THEATRE

SPECIAL NOTES FROM CCRT

INDIAN THEATRE

NOTES FROM CCRT

BHAND PATHER



- 1 Bhand Pather, the traditional theatre form of Kashmir, is a unique combination of dance, music and acting.
- 2 Satire, wit and parody are preferred for inducing laughter.
- 3 In this theatre form, music is provided with surnai, nagaara and dhol.
- 4 Since the actors of Bhand Pather are mainly from the farming community, the impact of their way of living, ideals and sensitivity is discernible in the theatre form.

INDIAN THEATRE

NOTES FROM CCRT

BHAONA



- 1 Bhaona is a presentation of the **Ankia Naat** of Assam.
- 2 In Bhaona cultural glimpses of Assam, Bengal, Orissa, Mathura and Brindavan can be seen.
- 3 The Sutradhaar, or narrator begins the story, first in **Sanskrit** and then in either **Brajboli** or **Assamese**.

INDIAN THEATRE

NOTES FROM CCRT

DASHAVATAR

- 1 Dashavatar is the most developed theatre form of the Konkan and Goa regions.



- 2 The performers personify the ten incarnations of Lord Vishnu -the god of preservation and creativity.



INDIAN THEATRE

NOTES FROM CCRT

DASHAVATAR



- 3 The ten incarnations are Matsya (fish), Kurma (tortoise), Varaha (boar), Narsimha (lion-man), Vaman (dwarf), Parashuram, Rama, Krishna (or Balrama), Buddha and Kalki.
- 4 Apart from stylized make-up, the Dashavatar performers wear masks of **wood and papier mache**.

INDIAN THEATRE

NOTES FROM CCRT

MUDIYETTU

- 1 Mudi yettu, a traditional folk theatre form of Kerala is celebrated in the month of Vrischikam (November-December).



- 2 It is usually performed only in the Kali temples of Kerala, as an oblation to the Goddess.
- 3 It depicts the triumph of goddess Bhadrakali over the asura Darika.
- 4 The seven characters in Mudi yettu- Shiva, Narada, Darika, Danavendra, Bhadrakali, Kooli and Koimbidar (Nandikeshvara) are all heavily made-up.

INDIAN THEATRE

NOTES FROM CCRT

THERUKOOTHU

- 1 Therukoothu, the most popular form of folk drama of Tamil Nadu, literally means "street play".



- 2 It is mostly performed at the time of annual temple festivals of Mariamman (Rain goddess) to achieve rich harvest.
- 3 At the core of the extensive repertoire of Therukoothu there is a cycle of eight plays based on the life of Draupadi.
- 4 Kattiakaran, the Sutradhara of the Therukoothu performance, gives the gist of the play to the audience and Komali entertains the audience with his buffoonery.

PREVIOUS YEAR'S QUESTIONS
– MAINS

2011

1 Write a sentence each on any five of the following traditional theatre forms:

- a) Bhand Pather
- b) Swang
- c) Maach
- d) Bhaona
- e) Mudi yettu
- f) Dhashavatar

1987

2 Where did the following traditional Folk Theatres originate?

- 1) Jatra
- 2) Kuttiyatam
- 3) Nautanki
- 4) Tamasha
- 5) Bhavai

PREVIOUS YEAR'S QUESTIONS
– MAINS

1995, 2005, 2007

2 Write about Yakshagana.

1985

3 What efforts have been made to develop theatre in India? Name any two important persons associated with the development of this art.**UPSC**

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